Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Psychology**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**To what extent does listening to music lessen the symptoms of ADHD?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	The research is relevant to the topic of investigation, clear and relatively focused. The introduction operationalizes "the symptoms of ADHD" as attention and hyperactivity (5 – 6); the selected research is relevant with some explanation (3 – 4); the structure of the essay effectively supports communication of the research (5 – 6).	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Relevant research materials are used to establish knowledge of the subject matter (5 – 6); there is some use of relevant psychological terminology (3 – 4); some relevant concepts are explained, but there is a limited explanation of why music may improve symptoms of ADHD. (3 – 4)	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The essay includes analysis that is partially effective; the findings of Madjar are not clearly linked to attention; the study by Motello and Coons compares therapies, but the link back to the question needs to be better explained. The value of Vorster to the argument needs more clarity. (3 – 4) A partially consistent line of argument; the conclusion is a repetition of the evaluation of the research rather than drawing a clear conclusion about the research question. Some areas of uncertainty are addressed in the conclusion. (3 – 4)	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**4**	The discussion is partially balanced with regard to the significance of the findings. The discussion instead focuses more on issues that were not directly addressed in the research – age and culture. (3 – 4) There is some evaluation of the evidence that is used; this often needed development. Some points – e.g., temporal validity – were superficial while more significant issues with the research were not addressed (3 - 4).	

E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**1**	The reflection on the extended essay learning experience is descriptive (1); reflection on the student's grown is limited to a description of the process and there is no evidence of transfer of learning (1).
Total marks awarded	18/30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	The essay is focused on the question but has a tendency to be descriptive. Studies are described but the reasoning behind the use of music to treat ADHD is not well addressed in the essay. The approach to evaluation is inconsistent, with some good points made, but a tendency toward superficial evaluation. There is a lack of psychological terminology in the discussion and evaluation of the research. The conclusions lack a clear evaluation of the strength of the candidate's argument.	